01 / VISUAL LITERACY

Read an image in layers.



Figure 1 / fictional illustration, not evidence / curated image source in provenance.json

This course treats visual reading as a sequence of description, attention and interpretation. The illustrations are authored images, not documentary evidence of real places.

Start with what is present, then ask how it is arranged, then consider possible meanings. Keep those three layers visible in your notes.

Visible elements / arrangement / possible reading

Working record: Describe the classroom image in three sentences, one for each layer. Keep your first attempt and your revised version so the change remains visible.

Visible elements

Write your visible elements here.

arrangement

Write your arrangement here.

possible reading

Write your possible reading here.

Describe the classroom image in three sentences, one for each layer.

02 / VISUAL LITERACY

Mark the composition.



Figure 1 / fictional illustration, not evidence / curated image source in provenance.json

Locate the largest shapes and their relationship to the frame. Describe position and proportion in ordinary language rather than claiming exact measurements from a stylised illustration.

A bright table may sit low in the frame while a dark wall forms the background. The contrast can guide attention without proving which object matters to the people shown.

Foreground / middle ground / background / focal area

Working record: Sketch a simple composition map using no more than five labelled shapes. Keep your first attempt and your revised version so the change remains visible.

Foreground

Write your foreground here.

middle ground

Write your middle ground here.

background

Write your background here.

focal area

Write your focal area here.

Sketch a simple composition map using no more than five labelled shapes.

03 / VISUAL LITERACY

Build a colour vocabulary.



Figure 2 / fictional illustration, not evidence / curated image source in provenance.json

Name hue, relative lightness and contrast separately. A colour description is more precise when it explains a relationship instead of assigning a universal mood.

Cobalt blue beside mustard yellow creates a strong visible contrast. Calling that contrast cheerful is an interpretation that another viewer may not share.

Colour pair / contrast / tentative association

Working record: Describe two colour relationships and label any emotional association as your interpretation. Keep your first attempt and your revised version so the change remains visible.

Colour pair

Write your colour pair here.

contrast

Write your contrast here.

tentative association

Write your tentative association here.

Describe two colour relationships and label any emotional association as your interpretation.

04 / VISUAL LITERACY

Trace the order of attention.



Figure 2 / fictional illustration, not evidence / curated image source in provenance.json

Record where you looked first, second and third, then ask which visible features might explain that route. Your viewing order is a personal observation, not a population result.

A pale sheet against a dark tabletop may attract attention through contrast. Another reader may notice a face first. Neither route is a measured general rule.

First noticed / next noticed / visible cue

Working record: Write your attention sequence and compare it with a second possible route. Keep your first attempt and your revised version so the change remains visible.

First noticed

Write your first noticed here.

next noticed

Write your next noticed here.

visible cue

Write your visible cue here.

Write your attention sequence and compare it with a second possible route.

05 / VISUAL LITERACY

Distinguish object from symbol.



Figure 3 / fictional illustration, not evidence / curated image source in provenance.json

An object can support more than one symbolic reading. Connect a proposed meaning to the image and its context rather than treating a symbol as a fixed dictionary entry.

An open notebook might suggest learning, unfinished work or simply a useful tabletop object. The image alone does not decide among those readings.

Object / possible meaning / supporting clue / uncertainty

Working record: Offer two readings of one object without selecting a definitive meaning. Keep your first attempt and your revised version so the change remains visible.

Object

Write your object here.

possible meaning

Write your possible meaning here.

supporting clue

Write your supporting clue here.

uncertainty

Write your uncertainty here.

Offer two readings of one object without selecting a definitive meaning.

06 / VISUAL LITERACY

Compare two visual choices.



Figure 3 / fictional illustration, not evidence / curated image source in provenance.json

Use the same comparison dimensions for both images. A consistent comparison is easier to inspect than a sequence of personal preferences.

Compare where the brightest area appears, how figures are grouped and which edges are cropped. Avoid turning a compositional difference into a claim about actual behaviour.

Dimension / image A / image B / interpretation

Working record: Complete a three-row comparison using composition, contrast and grouping. Keep your first attempt and your revised version so the change remains visible.

Dimension

Write your dimension here.

image A

Write your image a here.

image B

Write your image b here.

interpretation

Write your interpretation here.

Complete a three-row comparison using composition, contrast and grouping.

07 / VISUAL LITERACY

Ask where the image came from.



Figure 4 / fictional illustration, not evidence / curated image source in provenance.json

Record authorship, production method and what the source actually supplies. These case illustrations are AI-generated editorial images, with individual provenance listed alongside the document.

A source note establishes how an asset was selected; it does not establish that the depicted lesson took place. Keep illustration provenance separate from claims about a real subject.

Asset / production method / source note / evidence limit

Working record: Write a caption that identifies an illustration without presenting it as a photograph of an event. Keep your first attempt and your revised version so the change remains visible.

Asset

Write your asset here.

production method

Write your production method here.

source note

Write your source note here.

evidence limit

Write your evidence limit here.

Write a caption that identifies an illustration without presenting it as a photograph of an event.

08 / VISUAL LITERACY

Name the edge of interpretation.



Figure 4 / fictional illustration, not evidence / curated image source in provenance.json

List what cannot be established from the image. Being explicit about the boundary makes a visual analysis more useful, not less imaginative.

Attendance, accessibility, learning outcomes and relationships between the figures are not supplied by the illustration. These would require relevant independent information.

Interpretation / missing context / needed source

Working record: Choose one tempting claim and name the source that would be needed to examine it. Keep your first attempt and your revised version so the change remains visible.

Interpretation

Write your interpretation here.

missing context

Write your missing context here.

needed source

Write your needed source here.

Choose one tempting claim and name the source that would be needed to examine it.

09 / VISUAL LITERACY

Compose a short visual analysis.



Figure 5 / fictional illustration, not evidence / curated image source in provenance.json

Bring description, arrangement and interpretation into a compact paragraph. Mark the transition between an observable feature and your proposed reading.

A useful sentence might begin The bright table contrasts with the darker wall, followed by I read this as a focus on shared work. The wording keeps the interpretation attributable to the reader.

Description / arrangement / interpretation / boundary

Working record: Write a short analysis with one clearly marked interpretive sentence. Keep your first attempt and your revised version so the change remains visible.

Description

Write your description here.

arrangement

Write your arrangement here.

interpretation

Write your interpretation here.

boundary

Write your boundary here.

Write a short analysis with one clearly marked interpretive sentence.

10 / VISUAL LITERACY

Keep a visual reading archive.



Figure 5 / fictional illustration, not evidence / curated image source in provenance.json

Save the source note, composition map, comparison and final analysis together. The archive records your reading process rather than certifying a correct interpretation.

Use an earlier and later caption to show how your language became more precise. Record one question that the images could not answer.

Artifact / revision / lesson / next question

Working record: Choose one sentence whose evidence boundary became clearer and explain the revision. Keep your first attempt and your revised version so the change remains visible.

Artifact

Write your artifact here.

revision

Write your revision here.

lesson

Write your lesson here.

next question

Write your next question here.

Choose one sentence whose evidence boundary became clearer and explain the revision.